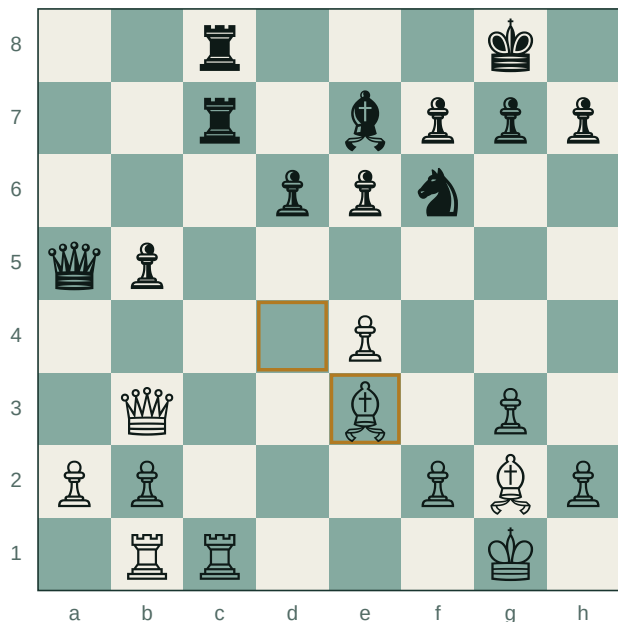


Pins and pressure: Black, move 21

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 21.Be3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21...Rxc1+ 22. Rxc1 Rxc1+ 23. Bxc1 Qe1+ 24. Bf1 Qxc1

21...Rxc1+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From c1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on b1. Recorded reply: **22.Rxc1**.

22...Rxc1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on c1. Recorded reply: **23.Bxc1**.

23...Qe1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From e1 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on c1. Recorded reply: **24.Bf1**.

24...Qxc1 The queen captures the bishop on c1.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.